LAST EXIT ON 285

AN ORIGINAL THRILLER FROM NCCA ENTERTAINMENT

ONE NIGHT. ONE EXIT. 6:00 AM.

LOGLINE

> *A former Army MP driving rideshare to keep her daughter in private school has until a 6:00 AM trailer leaves Atlanta to get her child back from the traffickers her ex-husband sold her to.*

THE STORY

Renee Carter drives the Perimeter all night so her daughter Kayla can stay at a Sandy Springs prep school they can barely afford. Tuition is due at 8:00 AM. Kayla has a secret of her own: a scholarship to an arts magnet school, and a form her mother keeps promising to sign after this shift.

At 12:38 AM Renee accepts a surge ride from a freight depot on Fulton Industrial. Her passenger is Jonah, a bookkeeper running with a duffel of cash and a ledger that lists girls by age next to shipments of peaches. The men chasing him know exactly where Renee is, because her charming ex-husband Victor shared her location at dinner to pay down a gambling debt.

By 2:00 AM Kayla has been taken from their East Point townhouse by a family friend and locked in a refrigerated trailer bound for Savannah at six. Renee has lost her car, her phone and her daughter's signal. To get Kayla back she has to trust the man who abandoned her, call the sergeant she hasn't spoken to in eleven years, and pick up a weapon for the first time since a checkpoint in Kandahar.

WHY LIFETIME

WHO SHE IS

A competent working mother and veteran who fights smart, freezes under a real trauma trigger, and still gets cornered.

WHAT THREATENS HER

A betrayal from inside the family. The man who brought dinner and new Jordans is the reason her car was marked.

WHY NO ONE CAN FIX IT

The local detective is on the traffickers' payroll, and every call she makes can be traced back to her daughter.

WHAT SHE STANDS TO LOSE

Her only child, before sunrise. And the version of herself she spent eleven years putting away.

COMPS

Collateral's one-night driver and passenger engine, *Taken*'s parent-rescue drive, grounded in a working Atlanta mother's point of view and the ordinary places she drives through every night: the Perimeter, Fulton Industrial, the Waffle House on Camp Creek.

THE NIGHT

3:47 PM	Car line in Sandy Springs. The $8,000 tuition notice arrives.
7:52 PM	Victor borrows Renee's phone at dinner and shares her location.
12:38 AM	The pickup at Dixon Freight. The first chase onto I-285.
1:58 AM	Boxed in at a QuikTrip. Kayla climbs out her window and is taken.
2:50 AM	Waffle House. Victor confesses. Jonah steals the car.
3:20 AM	Stranded in a closed work zone, Renee makes the call.
5:47 AM	The freight yard. Roman's terms: you can only take one of them home.
6:00 AM	The truck is supposed to leave.

TRAILER MOMENTS

- A passenger's bag tears open in a MARTA bus bay: banded hundreds and a ledger with ages in the produce column.
- Renee freezes in a QuikTrip aisle at a child's light-up sneakers, and a cashier with a bat and a trucker step in.
- Kayla, fifteen, slides a tracking tag into her sock before she's taken.
- Four girls in a refrigerated trailer take apart the lock with a pallet-jack pin and a braid cuff.
- Renee dials her old sergeant by her first name, the signal that means come now.
- One shot to a truck's red air line locks forty tons of trailer at the gate.

PRODUCTION FOOTPRINT

- One night, one metro area, built for an Atlanta shoot.
- Two road sequences, one freight-yard climax, a small cast of principals.
- Mostly standing Atlanta businesses and industrial exteriors.
- Violence carries consequence. Survivor characters drive their own escape.

Written by Kelly R. Tenney

POSSIBLE CAST

A wish list to guide packaging. Availability, interest and representation are unverified, and no one listed is attached.

Renee Carter

Former Army MP turned rideshare driver. Controlled, funny, afraid of her own training.

Danielle Deadwyler REACH Atlanta native with prestige weight from *Till* and *Station Eleven*.

Nicole Beharie CORE The working mother of *Miss Juneteenth*, the action lead of *Sleepy Hollow*.

Yaya DaCosta CORE A proven Lifetime lead since *Whitney*, with authority from *Chicago Med*.

Meagan Good COMMERCIAL Recognizable and audience-friendly from *Harlem* and *Think Like a Man*.

Kayla Carter

Fifteen. Artist, camera tinkerer, the one who sends the clue.

Saniyya Sidney CORE *King Richard* and *Fences*. Can carry the kitchen scene opposite a heavyweight lead.

Akira Akbar CORE Young Monica in *Captain Marvel*. Grounded and quick.

Open Atlanta search PRACTICAL An actor 18 or older playing fifteen simplifies the overnight schedule and vehicle work.

Jonah Price

Bookkeeper, courier, liar, brother.

Jovan Adepo REACH *Fences* and *Watchmen*. Real moral weight for a man who looked away.

Lamorne Morris CORE *Fargo* range behind the *New Girl* timing.

Brandon Micheal Hall CORE Warm, anxious leading-man energy from *God Friended Me*.

Victor Carter

The charming ex. Real love for his daughter, weaker than his debts.

Lance Gross CORE Effortless charm and an Atlanta audience from *House of Payne*.

Trai Byers CORE *Empire*'s Andre. Charm covering shame.

Rotimi COMMERCIAL *Power* fan base and dinner-table charisma.

Roman

The accountant in the cardigan. Treats people as line items.

Stephen Root CORE *Barry* showed how frightening he is at low volume.

Željko Ivanek CORE Emmy winner for *Damages*. Precise, unreadable menace.

Michael Kelly CORE *House of Cards* fixer. Calm competence as a threat.

Sgt. Denise Holloway

GBI agent, Renee's old sergeant.

Aunjanue Ellis-Taylor REACH *King Richard*. Instant history with any scene partner.

Adina Porter CORE *The Newsroom* and *True Blood*. Dry authority and warmth.

Mia Price

Nineteen. Tactical, distrustful, unforgiving of her brother.

Priah Ferguson CORE Atlanta native from *Stranger Things*, now old enough for the role.

Lovie Simone CORE *Greenleaf*. Guarded intensity for the ambulance confrontation.

Marcus Doyle

Family friend, trapped by debt, with one decent choice.

Brian Tyree Henry REACH Atlanta through and through. The warmest face for the worst betrayal.

Omar Dorsey CORE *Queen Sugar*. A big, gentle presence that curdles.

Deon Cole CORE *black-ish*. Uncle energy that makes the turn hurt.

Ms. Pearl

GDOT night flagger. One scene, one reversed paddle.

Loretta Devine CAMEO A single scene she would make unforgettable. **Jenifer Lewis** CAMEO Wit and grace for a closed lane at 3:00 AM.